PLAYER 2 LEVEL UP · POLICY

ONLINE SAFETY POLICY

POLICY OWNER	Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up
SAFEGUARDING LEAD	Rory Horseman
DATE ADOPTED	11 November 2026
NEXT REVIEW	11 November 2027

1. OUR COMMITMENT

Player 2 Level Up is committed to providing a safe, supportive and inclusive online environment for children and young people participating in gaming and mentoring sessions.

We recognise that gaming can support confidence, communication, emotional wellbeing and social development. We also understand that online environments can present risks.

We aim to help young people enjoy gaming safely while developing awareness, confidence and responsible online behaviours.

2. UNDERSTANDING ONLINE RISKS

We recognise four main areas of online risk:

- **Content:** Exposure to inappropriate, harmful or upsetting material.
- **Contact:** Grooming, exploitation or inappropriate communication with others online.
- **Conduct:** Cyberbullying, harassment, discrimination or unsafe online behaviour.
- **Commerce:** Scams, gambling-like features, in-game purchases and financial exploitation.

Mentors will remain alert to these risks and respond appropriately to concerns arising during sessions.

3. SAFE GAMING AND COMMUNICATION

All gaming sessions must take place using agreed platforms and communication methods.

Mentors must:

- Use their Player 2 staff accounts, protected with two-step verification, and approved communication channels.
- Maintain professional boundaries at all times.
- Avoid personal social media connections or unauthorised contact outside sessions.
- Never send friend requests to young people, or accept friend requests from them.
- Use appropriate privacy settings and moderation tools.
- Never request passwords, sensitive personal details or inappropriate images.
- Take reasonable steps to protect young people from harmful online interactions.

Outside scheduled sessions, young people can talk in public voice channels, chat, comment and upload clips in the Player 2 Discord server. These spaces are open to members and moderated by

Player 2 Level Up. Staff and mentors must keep all contact with young people to these public channels or to scheduled sessions. Any private contact outside sessions, including direct messages, must be agreed with parents or carers in advance, remain professional and be recorded.

4. THE PLAYER 2 DISCORD SERVER

Player 2 Level Up is run as a Discord community. Members can chat in text channels, talk in public voice channels, comment on and upload clips, and take part in events and sessions.

Joining the server

- A parent or carer signs up on the young person's behalf through Whop and gives their consent.
- Members must be aged 13 to 17, in line with Discord's minimum age of 13.
- Game channels are unlocked to match the highest PEGI age rating the parent or carer allows.
- Discord access is removed when a membership ends.
- Members leave the server when they turn 18.
- The server is for young people only. Parents and carers do not join it, but they can contact us at any time at player2levelup@gmail.com.

Community rules

All members agree to follow the Player 2 community rules and Discord's Community Guidelines. Members must:

- Be kind and respectful in text chat, voice channels, comments and uploads.
- Keep personal information private, including surnames, addresses, schools, phone numbers, passwords and links to other social media.
- Only share content that is suitable for everyone in the server.
- Never share or ask for images of themselves or other people.
- Only use screen sharing to show games. Turning a camera on is always optional, and no one should be pressured to do so.
- Report anything that makes them feel worried or uncomfortable.

Moderation

- The server is moderated by Rory Horseman and approved moderators, who have completed the checks in our Safer Recruitment Policy.
- Discord's AutoMod automatically blocks harmful language, spam, phone numbers and other contact details, and attempts to move conversations off the server. The member sees a message asking them to keep personal details private and to tell a moderator if someone asked for them.
- AutoMod also alerts moderators to certain safeguarding words, without blocking the message, so they can check in with the young person. Blocked messages and alerts go to a private moderators' channel.

- An activity log, kept by the Carl-bot moderation bot in a private staff channel, records when members join, leave or move between voice channels, and when messages are edited or deleted. It does not record what is said in voice channels. Only Rory and approved moderators can see it, and it is used to check what happened when a concern is reported.
- Only bots approved by Rory can be added to the server. At present these are Carl-bot (activity log), Craig (recording One-2-One and Squad Up sessions) and Whop (memberships).
- Clips, uploads and comments must follow the community rules and can be removed by moderators.
- Moderators can remove messages, mute or time out members, and remove members who break the rules. Serious or repeated breaches may lead to a membership being ended, and parents or carers will be told.
- Moderation actions are recorded in line with our Data Protection Policy.
- Any safeguarding concern that comes up in the server is handled under our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.

Private messages and voice rooms

- Player 2 Level Up cannot see direct messages between members. We encourage young people and their parents or carers to set Discord's privacy settings so that only friends can send direct messages, and parents or carers can use Discord's Family Center.
- Staff and mentors do not send direct messages to young people unless this has been agreed with parents or carers in advance.
- Private voice rooms included with some memberships are for groups of members, follow the same community rules and can be checked by moderators at any time.
- Staff and mentors must not be alone in a voice room with a young person, except during a booked One-2-One session.

One-2-One sessions

- For members, One-2-One sessions take place in the private One-2-One voice channel, which only Rory, the booked young person and the Craig recording bot can join. Parents or carers give the young person's Discord username when booking. Rory adds them to the channel before the session and removes their access afterwards.
- Young people who are not members have their One-2-One on Google Meet, or another platform agreed with their parent or carer, using Player 2 Level Up's own accounts. Rory sends the link to the parent or carer, and never uses his personal phone number or personal accounts.
- One-2-One sessions are recorded for safeguarding, to protect both the young person and Rory. Parents and carers are told this, and agree to it, when they book.
- Rory tells the young person at the start of every session that it is being recorded.
- On Discord, the Craig bot records audio only, so cameras and screen sharing are not recorded. On Google Meet or another platform, Rory records the session using Player 2 Level Up's own accounts or computer, and the same rules apply.

- Rory saves each recording to Player 2 Level Up's secure storage. It is kept for 30 days and then deleted, unless it is needed because a concern has been raised. Craig deletes its own copy within 7 days.

Squad Up sessions

- Squad Up with Rory sessions are for members only and take place in the private Squad Up with Rory voice channel, which only Rory, the booked squad and the Craig recording bot can join. Rory adds the squad before the session and removes their access afterwards.
- Squad Up sessions are recorded for safeguarding in the same way as One-2-One sessions, using the Craig bot (audio only). Parents and carers are told about this when they sign up for membership, and the parent or carer who books agrees to it.
- Rory tells everyone at the start of every session that it is being recorded.
- Squad Up recordings are stored, kept and deleted in the same way as One-2-One recordings.

Reporting a concern

Young people can report anything that worries them to a moderator, through Discord's own reporting tools, or by telling a parent or carer. Parents and carers can contact us at player2levelup@gmail.com. If a child is in immediate danger, call 999.

The server is not monitored 24 hours a day. If no moderator is online and a young person needs help, they should talk to a trusted adult or contact Childline on 0800 1111 or at childline.org.uk.

5. AGE-APPROPRIATE GAMES AND INDIVIDUAL NEEDS

We recognise that young people have different interests, abilities and levels of maturity.

Games will be considered individually, taking account of PEGI age ratings, content, online features and the young person's needs.

Where a young person and their parent or carer request a game rated above the young person's age, this may be considered in accordance with our Age-Appropriate Games Policy.

A higher age rating does not automatically prevent a game from being played, provided the mentor has assessed its suitability and has no safeguarding concerns.

6. ONLINE BEHAVIOUR AND WELLBEING

We encourage respectful communication and positive online interactions.

Mentors will:

- Promote kindness, inclusion and appropriate online behaviour.
- Respond calmly to frustration or emotional distress.
- Challenge bullying, discrimination and inappropriate behaviour.
- Support young people in recognising unsafe situations and knowing how to seek help.
- Encourage balanced and positive gaming habits, taking account of individual needs.

We recognise that some young people may communicate or respond differently due to neurodivergence, anxiety or other needs. Our approach will remain flexible, supportive and non-judgemental.

7. RESPONDING TO ONLINE SAFETY CONCERNS

Any online safety concern must be taken seriously.

Where a concern arises, mentors must:

1. **Act promptly** to protect the young person, including pausing or ending a session where necessary.
2. **Listen calmly** and avoid judgement or unnecessary questioning.
3. **Report the concern** to the nominated safeguarding lead as soon as possible.
4. **Record the facts**, including relevant messages, dates, times and actions taken.
5. **Follow safeguarding procedures**, including contacting statutory services where necessary.

Relevant evidence must be preserved safely and lawfully. Suspected child sexual abuse images must not be downloaded, forwarded or circulated.

Where a child is in immediate danger, emergency services must be contacted without delay.

8. WORKING WITH PARENTS AND CARERS

We recognise the important role parents and carers play in supporting online safety.

We will encourage open communication about gaming platforms, privacy settings, age ratings and any concerns relating to their child's online experiences.

Where appropriate, we will share information and guidance to help families support safe and responsible gaming outside sessions.

9. PRIVACY, IMAGES AND RECORDINGS

Personal information relating to young people and families will be handled securely and in accordance with our Data Protection Policy.

Apart from One-2-One and Squad Up sessions, which are recorded as set out in section 4, sessions must not be recorded, photographed, streamed or shared publicly without appropriate authorisation, a lawful basis and suitable safeguards. Public voice channels in the Discord server are not recorded.

Staff must not share identifiable information, images or recordings of young people through personal accounts or unauthorised platforms.

Session recordings, AutoMod alerts and the activity log are only used to keep young people and staff safe. They are never shared publicly. They may be shared with children’s social care, the police or the LADO where this is needed to protect a child, in line with our Data Protection Policy.

10. SAFEGUARDING RESPONSIBILITIES AND REPORTING

Rory Horseman, as owner of Player 2 Level Up, is responsible for ensuring that appropriate safeguarding and online safety procedures are followed.

Lorraine Payne, Designated Safeguarding Lead at Willow Warwickshire Ltd, provides voluntary external safeguarding advice under a separate agreement. This does not transfer safeguarding responsibility to Willow Warwickshire Ltd.

Concerns about Rory's conduct may be reported directly to the relevant Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO).

Safeguarding contacts

- **Nominated Safeguarding Lead:** Rory Horseman — player2levelup@gmail.com
- **External Safeguarding Adviser:** Lorraine Payne, Willow Warwickshire Ltd
- **Warwickshire LADO:** 01926 745376
- **LADO email:** lado@warwickshire.gov.uk
- **Warwickshire Children's Social Care:** 01926 414144
- **Emergency Duty Team:** 01926 886922
- **Emergency Services:** 999

Where an allegation about an adult meets the LADO referral criteria, the appropriate Position of Trust referral process must be followed.

11. POLICY REVIEW

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner following a significant incident, changes in technology or relevant safeguarding guidance.

It should be read alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy, Staff Code of Conduct, Behaviour Policy, Age-Appropriate Games Policy and Data Protection Policy.

Approved by Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up, on 11 November 2026. Next review due 11 November 2027.